Michael Irwin

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Citizenship: United States

Fields of Interest

Primary: Macroeconomics, Household Finance, Macro-Finance
Secondary: Labor Economics

Current Position

Senior Economist 2021–present
Bank of Canada *Ottawa, ON*
Financial Stability Department; Economic and Financial Research Department
Model Development and Research Division

Education

Ph.D. Economics 2021
Ohio State University *Columbus, OH*
Advisors: Kyle Dempsey and Aubhik Khan

M.A. Economics 2016
Ohio State University *Columbus, OH*

B.A. Economics 2015
University of Cincinnati *Cincinnati, OH*

Publications

1. "The Impact of Unemployment Insurance and Unsecured Credit on Business Cycles." *Journal of Political Economy Macroeconomics*, vol. 3, no. 2, 2025, pp. 199–244.

Working Papers

1. "Mortgage Interest Rate Risk and the Propagation of Shocks" (with Matías Vieyra)
2. "The Consumption Stimulus Effects of Student Debt Forgiveness Policies" (with Heejeong Kim)
3. "Bankruptcy Reform and the Relationship Between Student Loans and Credit Card Debt" (with Heejeong Kim)

Policy Work

- Developed Nexus-HANK, the Bank of Canada's Heterogeneous Agent New Keynesian model for policy analysis (with Matías Vieyra)
- "The Aggregate and Heterogeneous Effects of Responding to Shelter Inflation" (with Matías Vieyra). *Bank of Canada Staff Analytical Paper* 2026-5
  - Analysis contributed to the Bank of Canada's 2026 Inflation Target Renewal

- "The Aggregate Effects of Mortgage Stress Testing Policies" (with Jeongwoo Moon and Matías Vieyra). *Bank of Canada Staff Analytical Paper*, forthcoming

Presentations

- 2026: University of Cincinnati, Midwest Macroeconomics Meetings, Econometric Society North American Summer Meeting*, Theories and Methods in Macroeconomics*
- 2025: BoC-BoJ-FRB Philadelphia Joint Macroeconomics Workshop, Canadian Macro Study Group*
- 2024: Bates College, Midwest Macroeconomics Meetings, FRB Philadelphia Consumer Finance and Macroeconomics Conference, EEA-ESEM Congress*
- 2023: Econometric Society North American Summer Meeting, Canadian Economics Association

* Presented by coauthor

Discussions

- 2024: "Mortgage Market Structure and the Transmission of Monetary Policy During the Great Inflation" by A. Hedlund, K. Larkin, K. Mitman, and S. Ozkan, Bank of Canada Housing Workshop

Professional Service

- Model Risk Working Group at the Bank of Canada (2025–present)
- Referee: *Bank of Canada Staff Working Papers* (2025)

Skills

Software: Fortran, Julia, Matlab, Stata

References

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